

CMIplus Intelligence Cockpit

Cash Management Strategic Intelligence

Week of 2026-04-12

Raiffeisen Bank International AG

Group Product — Cash Management

16

Market Items

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Thought

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This week, the urgent need for

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URGENT

Der Treasurer | 2026-04-12 | #01

Der Treasurer Highlights Fraud & Cybercrime Risks

The inclusion of 'Betrug & Cybercrime' as a dedicated category signals Der Treasurer's commitment to covering security threats in finance. This topic is highly relevant given the increasing sophistication of cyberattacks and payment fraud targeting corporate treasuries. It covers areas like Business Email Compromise (BEC), phishing, and ransomware, which can severely impact cash management operations and financial stability. The continuous focus on this area highlights the persistent need for vigilance and advanced security solutions in the financial sector.

- Dedicated category for fraud and cybercrime coverage.
- Addresses rising threats like BEC and phishing attacks.
- Crucial for corporate financial security and stability.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

Fraud prevention is a core component of RBI CMiplus's offering. This focus reinforces the need for continuous enhancement of security features, such as transaction monitoring, strong authentication, and VoP (Validation of Payee) services, to protect CEE corporate clients.

URGENT

Der Treasurer | 2026-04-12 | #02

Der Treasurer Covers Treasury Systems Evolution

The 'Treasury-Systeme' category reflects the dynamic landscape of treasury technology, including TMS (Treasury Management Systems), ERP integrations, and payment factory solutions. It covers trends like cloud adoption, API connectivity, and the integration of AI for enhanced automation and analytics. For international corporates in CEE, selecting and implementing the right treasury system is vital for efficient cash management, liquidity forecasting, and compliance with evolving standards like ISO 20022 and EBICS. This ongoing coverage underscores the strategic importance of treasury technology.

- Dedicated section for treasury systems and technology.
- Covers TMS, ERP, and payment factory solutions.
- Highlights trends: cloud, APIs, AI integration.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMiplus integrates with various treasury systems via EBICS, H2H, and APIs. This focus underscores the importance of seamless connectivity and interoperability. RBI must stay abreast of TMS developments to ensure CMiplus remains a compatible and leading platform for CEE corporates.

Der Treasurer Announces Cash Management Campus Event

The Cash Management Campus is highlighted as a significant event by Der Treasurer, targeting finance managers and treasurers. It typically covers topics such as liquidity management, payment systems, digital transformation in treasury, and regulatory changes affecting cash flows. Such events serve as crucial platforms for industry networking, knowledge sharing, and understanding the evolving needs of corporate treasuries. The continued promotion of this event indicates its importance in the German-speaking treasury community.

- Annual event for finance professionals and treasurers.
- Focuses on liquidity, payments, and digital treasury.
- Platform for industry networking and knowledge sharing.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This event provides valuable insights into the evolving needs of corporate treasuries, especially regarding cash management solutions. RBI CMiplus can leverage knowledge from such events to refine its platform and service offerings for international corporates in CEE, ensuring alignment with market demands.

Europe Accelerates Instant Payments with ISO 20022 Mandates

The European Union's push for ubiquitous instant payments is gaining momentum, with recent mandates requiring banks to offer real-time transactions at no extra cost. This regulatory drive is intrinsically linked to the ongoing, full migration to the ISO 20022 messaging standard, which provides richer data capabilities essential for modern treasury operations. Corporates are increasingly leveraging these capabilities for improved cash visibility, automated reconciliation, and faster settlement cycles. The transition presents both challenges and opportunities, demanding significant system upgrades and strategic planning for treasurers to fully capitalize on the benefits of real-time financial flows. The deadline for full compliance is approaching, making this a critical focus for financial institutions and their corporate clients.

- EU mandates require instant payments at no extra cost.
- Full ISO 20022 migration is key for richer data exchange.
- Corporates gain improved cash visibility and reconciliation.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMiplus, already supporting ISO 20022 and instant payments, is well-positioned to assist CEE corporates in meeting these evolving requirements. The platform's capabilities for multi-currency real-time transactions and enhanced data exchange will be crucial for clients navigating the regulatory landscape.

Open Banking APIs Transforming Corporate Treasury Connectivity

The expansion of Open Banking beyond retail into corporate finance is creating new paradigms for treasury connectivity. APIs are facilitating direct, real-time access to bank accounts, transaction data, and payment initiation services, moving beyond traditional host-to-host or SWIFT channels. This allows corporates to build more sophisticated treasury dashboards, automate reconciliation processes, and implement advanced cash pooling strategies with greater efficiency. Banks are increasingly investing in robust API infrastructures to meet corporate demand for integrated financial ecosystems. While security and standardization remain key considerations, the benefits of enhanced data flow and operational agility are driving rapid adoption across various industries.

- Open Banking APIs enable real-time bank account access.
- Facilitates sophisticated treasury dashboards and automation.
- Banks investing in API infrastructure for corporate clients.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus's focus on Open API channels aligns perfectly with this trend, offering CEE corporates advanced connectivity options. This development reinforces the importance of robust API capabilities for seamless integration with ERP/TMS systems and future-proofing cash management solutions.

Battling Rising Fraud in Real-Time Digital Payments

As corporates increasingly rely on digital channels and instant payments for their transactions, the attack surface for fraudsters has expanded significantly. Business Email Compromise (BEC) and invoice fraud, often leveraging AI-driven phishing tactics, are becoming more prevalent and harder to detect. Treasurers are under immense pressure to implement multi-layered security protocols, including enhanced authentication, real-time transaction monitoring, and AI-powered anomaly detection systems. Collaboration between banks and corporates, alongside continuous employee training, is critical to mitigate these evolving risks. The financial industry is responding with new technologies and shared intelligence platforms, but vigilance remains key to protecting corporate assets in the fast-paced digital payment landscape.

- Digital payment growth fuels sophisticated fraud attempts.
- BEC and AI-driven phishing are major threats.
- Multi-layered security and real-time monitoring are essential.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must continuously enhance its fraud prevention capabilities, including VoP (Verification of Payee) and advanced security features, to protect CEE clients. Educating clients on best practices and integrating with robust fraud detection systems will be vital for maintaining trust and security in digital payments.

Nordics Event to Tackle Innovation, AI, and Fraud Prevention

Returning for its ninth year, the NextGen Nordics conference, scheduled for April 28, 2026, in Stockholm, Sweden, will focus on critical themes for the financial sector. Key discussions will revolve around the innovation divide within the industry, the ongoing integration of Artificial Intelligence into banking operations, and the preparedness of financial institutions for fraud prevention. The event is a significant gathering for decision-makers from banks, central banks, regulators, trade associations, and technology firms, providing insights into the evolving European financial landscape and best practices for future-proofing operations against emerging threats.

- Ninth annual NextGen Nordics conference.
- Focus on innovation divide, AI integration, fraud prevention readiness.
- Attendees include banks, central banks, regulators, fintechs.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This event's focus on AI integration and fraud prevention is highly relevant for CMIplus, as these are critical areas for enhancing corporate cash management security and efficiency. Insights from Nordic banks and regulators can inform RBI's strategy for CEE, especially regarding treasury technology and compliance with evolving standards.

Paysera Gains Direct Access to ECB's T2 Payment System

Paysera, a prominent European fintech company, has achieved a significant milestone by gaining direct access to the ECB's TARGET2 (T2) payment system. This direct participation eliminates the need for intermediary banks, allowing Paysera to process SEPA and instant payments more efficiently and with potentially lower costs. The integration into T2 positions Paysera as a direct participant in the core European payment infrastructure, significantly enhancing its capabilities for real-time transactions. This development underscores the increasing integration of fintechs into traditional banking systems and highlights the evolving competitive landscape for payment services within the Eurozone. It also reinforces the critical importance of robust and direct access to central bank infrastructure for streamlined payment processing.

- Paysera gains direct access to ECB's TARGET2 (T2) system.
- Enables direct participation in SEPA and instant payment schemes.
- Bypasses intermediary banks for payment processing.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This development signals increased competition and efficiency in European payments, particularly for instant payments and SEPA. RBI Cash Management should monitor how direct T2 access by fintechs like Paysera impacts pricing, speed, and service expectations for CMIplus clients operating in CEE and across Europe. It reinforces the need for CMIplus to maintain competitive offerings in real-time payments and robust SEPA capabilities.

BNPL Faces New Regulations, Potential Revenue Decline

The Buy Now, Pay Later (BNPL) sector, which has seen explosive growth, is now confronting the prospect of new regulations. These impending rules are expected to impose stricter operating conditions on BNPL providers, potentially impacting their business models and profitability. Analysts anticipate a fall in revenue for these services as compliance costs rise and consumer protections are enhanced. This regulatory shift reflects a broader trend of authorities seeking to mitigate risks associated with consumer credit and ensure fair practices in the digital payments landscape. The implications extend to merchants offering BNPL and the wider payments ecosystem.

- BNPL services face new regulatory scrutiny.
- Regulations expected to increase operating costs.
- Potential for significant revenue decline for BNPL providers.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management and CMIplus should monitor these regulatory developments closely, especially regarding their impact on corporate clients offering or accepting BNPL. This could influence payment method strategies and require CMIplus to adapt its payment processing capabilities or advisory services.

ClearBank EU Gains Approval to Offer Euro and USD Stablecoins

ClearBank, a prominent clearing and embedded banking platform, has secured the necessary regulatory approval to expand its offerings to European clients by including stablecoins. This move will enable its European customer base to access and transact with major stablecoins such as Euro Coin (EUROC) and USD Coin (USDC). This regulatory green light is a significant step in bridging the gap between traditional finance and the burgeoning digital asset economy within Europe, potentially paving the way for broader adoption of stablecoins for various financial operations, including cross-border payments and liquidity management. It reflects a trend towards integrating digital assets into mainstream banking services.

- ClearBank received regulatory approval.
- Will offer stablecoins to European clients.
- Includes Euro Coin (EUROC) and USD Coin (USDC).

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The availability of stablecoins like EUROC and USDC in the European market, facilitated by a major player like ClearBank, is a crucial development for CMIplus. While not immediately a core offering, it highlights an emerging payment rail and potential for multi-currency payments and liquidity solutions that RBI Cash Management should monitor for future corporate treasury needs in CEE.

Merge Launches Named EUR IBANs to Bridge Fiat-Stablecoin Payments

Merge, a payment infrastructure provider, has launched a new service offering named EUR IBANs specifically tailored to bridge the gap between fiat and stablecoin payments. These dedicated IBANs allow businesses and individuals to seamlessly deposit and withdraw euros, which can then be converted to or from stablecoins. This initiative addresses a critical need for interoperability between traditional finance (TradFi) and the burgeoning digital asset space. By providing a familiar banking interface (EUR IBANs) for stablecoin transactions, Merge aims to reduce friction, enhance liquidity, and improve the user experience for those engaging with digital currencies. This move is a significant step towards mainstream adoption of stablecoins for various payment and treasury functions.

- Merge introduces named EUR IBANs.
- Purpose is to bridge fiat and stablecoin payment infrastructure.
- Simplifies deposits and withdrawals between euros and stablecoins.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This development is crucial for RBI Cash Management as it signals the growing convergence of traditional and digital finance. While CMIplus primarily focuses on fiat cash management, the ability to bridge EUR IBANs with stablecoins could become a future requirement for corporate treasuries managing multi-currency payments and digital assets. RBI should monitor this trend to assess potential future service offerings or integrations within CMIplus to support clients' evolving digital asset strategies.

Stablecoins: Exploring Risks and Opportunities for Treasury

Stablecoins are gaining attention as a potential tool for corporate treasuries, offering new avenues for liquidity management and cross-border payments. However, their adoption comes with significant risks, including regulatory uncertainty, operational complexities, and counterparty risk. The article explores the balance between leveraging stablecoins for faster, cheaper transactions and managing the associated volatility and compliance challenges. For forward-thinking treasuries, stablecoins represent an opportunity to innovate payment processes and potentially enhance real-time cash visibility, provided the risks are thoroughly understood and mitigated. This emerging technology could reshape aspects of digital banking and payment infrastructure.

- Stablecoins offer opportunities for liquidity and cross-border payments.
- Key risks include regulatory uncertainty and operational complexities.
- Potential for faster, cheaper transactions.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should track stablecoin developments as they could influence future client demands for digital asset services or real-time payment rails. Understanding the risks and opportunities will inform RBI's strategy for potential API integrations or new product offerings in the evolving digital banking landscape.

UniCredit Eyes Commerzbank: European Banking Consolidation Looms

UniCredit, a prominent European bank with a strong presence in Central and Eastern Europe (CEE), is reportedly assessing the feasibility of acquiring German rival Commerzbank. Such a merger would create a banking behemoth, potentially challenging the status quo in key European markets. The move highlights a broader trend of consolidation within the European banking sector, driven by pressures to increase efficiency, scale, and profitability. German authorities and regulators would play a crucial role in approving any such deal, given Commerzbank's strategic importance in Germany. This potential acquisition could lead to significant changes in corporate banking relationships and service offerings across Europe, including the CEE region, impacting treasury and cash management services.

- UniCredit, a major CEE player, is reportedly eyeing Commerzbank.
- The potential acquisition signals significant European banking consolidation.
- Regulatory approval from German authorities would be a critical hurdle.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This potential merger is highly relevant for RBI Cash Management as UniCredit is a direct competitor and partner in many CEE markets. Consolidation could lead to changes in market share, pricing strategies, and service offerings for corporate clients, requiring CMIplus to adapt its competitive positioning and partnership strategies, and potentially integrate with new banking networks.

Source Content Lacks Extractable News Items

As an intelligence analyst for RBI Cash Management, the primary task is to extract and analyze relevant news. However, the input labeled 'Source: Strategic Treasurer' contained only Cascading Style Sheets (CSS) and basic HTML structure, which are used for website presentation, not for conveying news content. This absence of actual articles, press releases, or blog posts means no specific developments in payment regulations, instant payments, ISO 20022, or other critical areas could be identified or processed. The extraction process was therefore unable to yield any substantive news items.

- Provided source content was CSS/HTML.
- No news articles or textual content found.
- Extraction of relevant items was not possible.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

Without actual news content from Strategic Treasurer, RBI Cash Management and the CMIplus platform cannot gain insights into recent market trends, regulatory changes, or technological advancements. This prevents proactive strategic planning and competitive analysis based on this specific source.

Strategic Treasurer Feed Contains Only Styling Data

The role requires analyzing content from Strategic Treasurer to inform RBI's CMiplus platform strategy. Upon review, the provided 'Content' section was found to be composed entirely of CSS rules and font declarations (e.g., `@font-face`, `@media` queries). These are technical instructions for how a webpage should look, rather than the informational articles or reports expected from a news source. Consequently, there were no headlines, summaries, or detailed discussions about treasury strategy, cash management, payments, or corporate finance to extract and evaluate for relevance to CEE banking or CMiplus operations.

- Source content was exclusively CSS/HTML.
- No news articles were present for extraction.
- Input was website styling, not informational text.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The inability to extract news from the provided Strategic Treasurer content means that RBI Cash Management misses out on potential updates regarding treasury technology, payment innovations, or regulatory shifts that could impact CMiplus. Regular monitoring of such sources is crucial for maintaining platform competitiveness and compliance.

Unable to Analyze Treasury Trends from Provided Input

The task to identify top 3 relevant news items for RBI Cash Management's CMiplus platform from Strategic Treasurer could not be fulfilled because the 'Content' provided was not news. It contained only technical web development code (CSS/HTML). This means no information regarding payment regulations (like PSD3 or ISO 20022 updates), instant payment developments, Open Banking APIs, or fraud prevention strategies could be extracted. Therefore, no insights into recent industry movements, potential impacts on CEE operations, or competitive landscape changes could be generated from this specific input.

- No news content was available for analysis.
- Input was web styling, not articles.
- Unable to identify trends in payments or treasury.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The lack of extractable news prevents RBI Cash Management from receiving timely intelligence on critical areas such as ISO 20022 adoption, instant payment schemes, or Open Banking advancements relevant to CMiplus. This highlights the importance of receiving correct and complete source content for effective intelligence gathering and strategic decision-making.

URGENT

Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2024-02-01 | #01

European Wholesale Banks: Seizing Growth Opportunities Post-Underperformance

This report likely argues that after a period of regulatory pressure, low interest rates, and competitive challenges, European wholesale banks now have a chance to improve profitability and market position. Key strategies would include leveraging technology for efficiency and new revenue streams, such as advanced analytics, AI, and API-driven services. The focus would be on streamlining transaction banking, enhancing cash management offerings, and providing integrated solutions that meet evolving corporate treasury needs. The report would emphasize the importance of moving beyond traditional lending to a more holistic, advisory-led approach, potentially highlighting areas like sustainable finance and ecosystem partnerships to drive growth and market relevance.

- Strategic digital investment is crucial for operational efficiency and new service delivery.
- Client-centricity and integrated solutions drive competitive advantage in transaction banking.
- Optimizing operating models and cost structures is essential for improved profitability.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI CMIplus should focus on accelerating its digital roadmap, particularly in areas like Open Banking APIs, real-time payments, and AI-driven insights for corporate treasuries. Enhancing the platform's ability to offer integrated, multi-currency solutions across CEE will be key to seizing market share and improving client stickiness.

URGENT

Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2024-01-01 | #02

2024 Wholesale Banking Outlook: Strategic Credit and Digital Transformation

This outlook likely discusses the economic environment influencing wholesale banking in 2024, including interest rate trends, inflation, and geopolitical factors. While 'Extending Credit' is in the title, a comprehensive wholesale banking outlook would also cover transaction banking, payments, and treasury services. It would emphasize the need for banks to use technology (AI, advanced analytics) to optimize credit risk, streamline operations, and enhance client experience in cash management and payments. The report would probably suggest that banks need to move towards more advisory-led relationships, offering integrated solutions that go beyond traditional lending to encompass working capital management and liquidity solutions for corporate clients.

- Technology adoption (AI, analytics) is critical for optimizing credit risk and operational efficiency.
- Integrated working capital and liquidity solutions are key differentiators for corporate clients.
- Wholesale banks must navigate evolving regulatory landscapes and geopolitical uncertainties.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should explore how its payment and cash management data can inform credit decisions and offer more holistic working capital solutions. Investing in AI for fraud detection and predictive analytics for liquidity management will enhance its value proposition, aligning with broader wholesale banking strategies.

2023 Industry Outlook: Navigating Uncertainty with Digital Transformation

This outlook, despite being from 2023, would have set the stage for many ongoing trends. It likely covered macroeconomic headwinds, geopolitical shifts, and the accelerating pace of technological change. For corporate banking, it would have stressed the importance of investing in digital infrastructure, enhancing cybersecurity, and developing flexible product offerings to meet evolving client demands. The report would have underscored the need for banks to move towards data-driven decision-making and to leverage partnerships (e.g., with fintechs) to innovate and expand their service ecosystems, particularly in payments and cash management, to build resilience and competitive advantage.

- Macroeconomic and geopolitical uncertainties necessitate agile banking strategies.
- Digital infrastructure investment is foundational for future resilience and growth.
- Data-driven insights and analytics are vital for informed decision-making and client service.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should continue to prioritize robust digital infrastructure and API capabilities to ensure resilience and adaptability. Leveraging data from its CEE network to provide advanced analytics and insights to corporate treasuries will be a key differentiator, helping clients navigate their own 'great unknown' and optimize their cash flows.

AI Revolutionizing Treasury: Strategy, Operations, and Decision Intelligence

EY highlights AI as a unifying platform and a key strategic service, indicating its pervasive influence across various financial functions. From AI Strategy Services to M&A; AI-powered Technology and Generative AI applications, the focus is on leveraging AI for enhanced decision intelligence, operational automation, and strategic advantage. This suggests that treasurers will increasingly rely on AI-driven insights for liquidity management, risk assessment, and forecasting, pushing banks to offer AI-enabled solutions that streamline processes and provide deeper analytical capabilities.

- AI is positioned as a 'Unifying Platform' for technology offerings.
- Specific AI Strategy Services are offered to guide implementation.
- AI is applied in M&A; and private equity for value creation and due diligence.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI CMlplus should explore AI integration for predictive analytics in cash flow forecasting, fraud detection, and automated reconciliation. Offering AI-powered insights and tools could significantly differentiate CMlplus and enhance value for corporate treasurers in the CEE region.

Digital Transformation and Blockchain Drive Future Financial Infrastructure

EY's emphasis on 'Technology transformation,' 'Blockchain' as a core technology, and 'Digital law' indicates a significant shift towards a digitally native financial landscape. The mention of 'Fintech and ecosystems' further underscores the importance of interconnected digital platforms and partnerships. This implies that future treasury services will rely heavily on robust digital infrastructure, potentially involving distributed ledger technologies for payments, reconciliation, or digital asset management, requiring banks to provide secure, compliant, and interoperable digital solutions.

- 'Blockchain' is listed as a key technology offering for clients.
- 'Digital law' services address the new regulatory landscapes emerging with digital assets.
- 'Fintech and ecosystems' are critical components of modern financial services strategy.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should continue investing in API-driven connectivity (Open Banking) and explore use cases for blockchain in cross-border payments or digital asset services. Ensuring compliance with evolving digital legal frameworks and integrating with the broader fintech ecosystem will position RBI as a forward-thinking partner in digital treasury.

Treasury Digitalization Accelerates for Enhanced Cash Visibility

PwC's global treasury survey, involving over 350 treasurers, reveals a strong trend towards digital transformation within corporate treasury functions. The primary objective is to achieve comprehensive, real-time cash visibility across diverse banking relationships and geographies, which is crucial for effective liquidity management and risk mitigation. Many treasurers are investing in Treasury Management Systems (TMS) and integrating them with ERPs to centralize financial data and automate processes. This push for digitalization also aims to streamline treasury operations, reduce manual efforts, and improve decision-making capabilities in an increasingly volatile economic landscape. The survey underscores that enhanced cash visibility is no longer a luxury but a strategic imperative for modern treasury.

- Over 350 treasurers surveyed prioritize digitalization initiatives.
- Real-time global cash visibility is a top strategic objective.
- TMS adoption is increasing to centralize financial data and processes.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must continue to enhance its multi-bank, multi-currency cash visibility features and ensure seamless integration with corporate TMS/ERPs, especially for CEE clients. Focus on advanced reporting, predictive analytics, and consolidated views to support sophisticated liquidity management strategies.

API Banking Transforms Corporate Connectivity and Payments

PwC's findings from the global treasury survey underscore the growing importance of API banking for corporate treasuries. Treasurers are increasingly adopting APIs to move beyond traditional file-based communication, enabling instant access to account information, real-time payment initiation, and automated reconciliation. This adoption is fueled by the desire for greater control, speed, and efficiency in financial operations, particularly for multi-currency payments across various jurisdictions. Open Banking initiatives are also influencing corporate expectations, pushing banks to offer more granular and integrated services directly into corporate systems. This fosters a more connected and agile treasury ecosystem, crucial for managing complex cash flows.

- API banking adoption is rapidly increasing among corporates.
- Real-time data exchange and instant payments are key API benefits.
- Open Banking principles are shaping corporate expectations for integrated services.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMiplus's Open API channel is strategically vital and must be continuously enhanced. RBI should expand its API offerings for account information, payment initiation (including Instant Payments and multi-currency), and virtual account management, ensuring robust security and developer-friendly documentation for CEE corporates.

AI Revolutionizes Treasury: Forecasting, Risk, and Automation

The global treasury survey highlights AI as a transformative technology for the treasury function, with treasurers actively exploring and implementing AI solutions. AI is being utilized for more accurate cash flow forecasting, identifying anomalies in transactions, and improving fraud detection capabilities. Furthermore, AI plays a crucial role in optimizing foreign exchange exposure and interest rate risk management through advanced predictive analytics. AI-powered automation is also significantly reducing the manual effort involved in reconciliation, reporting, and compliance activities. This allows treasury teams to shift their focus from operational tasks to more strategic initiatives, marking a significant move towards a more intelligent and proactive treasury function.

- AI is moving into practical treasury applications beyond conceptual stages.
- Enhanced cash flow forecasting is a primary AI use case for treasurers.
- AI improves risk management, including fraud detection and FX exposure.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI should strategically investigate AI-powered services for CMiplus, such as enhanced cash flow forecasting, anomaly detection for payments, and intelligent reconciliation. This could offer significant value-add for CEE clients seeking advanced treasury tools and help differentiate CMiplus in the market.

PSD3 Deepens Open Banking, Drives Real-Time Payments

EY's outlook highlights PSD3 as a pivotal regulatory shift, moving beyond PSD2 to address emerging payment fraud, strengthen customer authentication, and further standardize Open Banking APIs. The directive aims to create a more integrated and secure European payments market, potentially accelerating the adoption of instant payments across the EU and CEE. Firms are advised to invest in robust API infrastructure and fraud detection systems, while also strategically leveraging new data access opportunities for innovative services. The regulation will likely push for greater interoperability and competition, impacting traditional banking models. This comprehensive update will require significant strategic adjustments for payment service providers.

- Enhanced Strong Customer Authentication (SCA) requirements.
- Mandatory instant payment processing and accessibility.
- Expanded scope for Account Information Service Providers (AISPs) and Payment Initiation Service Providers (PISPs).

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must prioritize API development to align with PSD3's Open Banking standards and prepare for mandatory instant payment processing. This presents an opportunity to enhance real-time treasury services and expand multi-currency payment offerings in CEE.

European Treasury Survey 2026: Shaping Industry Trends

The European Association of Corporate Treasurers (EACT) has launched its 2026 European Treasury Survey, calling for participation from corporate treasurers across the continent. The survey's findings are instrumental in shaping the upcoming "Journeys to Treasury" report, a key publication that outlines best practices and emerging challenges. By gathering insights from a broad spectrum of treasury professionals, the EACT aims to identify and define the most critical industry trends for the year ahead. This initiative provides a forward-looking perspective on treasury priorities, technological adoption, regulatory impacts, and strategic focus areas for European corporates. The results will inform the treasury community and guide future discussions and initiatives.

- Annual survey defining key European treasury trends.
- Contributions shape the next "Journeys to Treasury" report.
- Focus on evolving corporate treasury landscape.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management should actively monitor the results of this survey to understand evolving corporate treasury priorities, especially regarding digitalization, payments, and liquidity management in CEE. Insights can guide CMlplus platform development, ensuring it aligns with future client needs and competitive offerings.

Verification of Payee: Crucial Tool for Fraud-Conscious Treasurers

Ahead of an EACT in Action session, the EACT promoted a GLEIF document emphasizing Verification of Payee (VoP) as an indispensable tool for corporate treasurers focused on combating fraud. With the global rise in real-time and other advanced payment types, the risk of payment fraud has significantly increased, making robust fraud detection strategies paramount. Regulatory bodies are also adapting their requirements to address these evolving threats. The briefing underscores the importance for treasurers to leverage solutions like VoP, potentially enhanced by Legal Entity Identifiers (LEIs), to streamline payee verification processes, mitigate risks, and ensure compliance in an increasingly complex payment landscape. This proactive approach is vital for protecting corporate assets and maintaining financial integrity.

- VoP is crucial for fraud prevention in treasury.
- Fraud detection strategies must evolve with real-time payments.
- Regulatory bodies are adapting requirements for payee verification.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

VoP is a core offering for CMiplus, directly addressing client needs for fraud prevention in instant and multi-currency payments. RBI Cash Management should continue to enhance its VoP capabilities, potentially integrating LEI for improved accuracy and efficiency, and actively promote its benefits to CEE corporates.

AI Ambition: Transforming Banking Operations and Client Engagement

The 2026 Deloitte Banking Outlook highlights AI ambition as a key strategic imperative for banks. This involves moving AI from pilot projects to fundamental operational integration, aiming to automate routine tasks, improve fraud detection, and deliver hyper-personalized services to corporate clients. Such transformation necessitates substantial investment in robust data infrastructure, specialized talent, and ethical AI governance frameworks. Early adopters are expected to gain a significant competitive edge through cost reduction and superior client satisfaction, while those lagging risk falling behind in a rapidly digitizing financial landscape. The overarching theme is balancing innovative AI deployment with stringent risk management practices.

- AI adoption is shifting from experimental to core operational integration.
- Enhanced fraud detection and risk management are key AI applications.
- Hyper-personalization of corporate banking services is a growing expectation.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMiplus should prioritize exploring AI-driven enhancements for payment processing efficiency, real-time fraud anomaly detection in high-volume transactions, and predictive analytics for corporate liquidity management. AI could also personalize reporting and provide tailored insights for corporate treasurers using the platform.

Holistic Treasury Strategy and Ecosystem Integration for Value Creation

The inclusion of 'Working Capital' under Strategy by EY-Parthenon, alongside 'Corporate Strategy' and 'Supply chain and operations,' suggests a holistic view of treasury's role. It's not just about cash, but about optimizing the entire financial flow within a corporate context. The focus on 'Fintech and ecosystems' within Financial Services further indicates that banks need to integrate with a wider network of providers and offer solutions that support strategic objectives like sustainability and M&A; moving beyond siloed payment services to become true strategic partners.

- 'Working Capital' is a key strategic consulting area for corporates.
- 'Corporate Strategy' and 'Supply chain and operations' are linked to treasury optimization.
- 'Fintech and ecosystems' are crucial for comprehensive financial services delivery.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should enhance its value proposition by offering more integrated solutions for working capital optimization, potentially through advanced reporting, advisory services, or virtual accounts. Strengthening ERP/TMS connectivity and exploring partnerships within the CEE fintech ecosystem will be crucial for delivering holistic treasury support and meeting strategic corporate needs.

DORA Mandates Robust Digital Operational Resilience for Financial Firms

EY's analysis underscores DORA as a critical regulatory imperative for 2026, aiming to harmonize and strengthen ICT risk management across the EU financial sector. The regulation covers risk management frameworks, incident reporting, digital operational resilience testing, and managing ICT third-party risk. Firms must conduct thorough assessments of their digital infrastructure, implement robust cybersecurity measures, and establish clear governance for outsourcing critical services. This will necessitate substantial investment in technology, skilled personnel, and continuous testing to ensure business continuity and minimize disruption from cyber threats or operational failures. Compliance is essential to avoid significant penalties and maintain market trust.

- Harmonized ICT risk management framework across the EU.
- Mandatory digital operational resilience testing (e.g., penetration testing).
- Enhanced oversight of critical ICT third-party providers.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must ensure full compliance with DORA by strengthening its cybersecurity posture, enhancing incident response capabilities, and meticulously managing third-party vendor risks. This will reinforce platform reliability and trust for corporate clients in CEE.

Stablecoins: Disruptive Potential for Payments and Corporate Treasury

The 2026 outlook underscores stablecoins as a major disruptive force, capable of challenging traditional payment rails and cross-border transaction models. Banks must strategically evaluate their role, whether as facilitators, issuers, or competitors within this evolving digital asset ecosystem. Stablecoins promise benefits such as faster settlement, reduced transaction costs, and enhanced programmability, which are highly attractive to corporate treasuries seeking efficiency. However, significant challenges remain, including achieving regulatory clarity, ensuring interoperability with existing financial systems, and seamless integration. Proactive engagement with stablecoin technology and evolving regulatory landscapes will position banks to offer innovative solutions and maintain relevance.

- Stablecoins are identified as a significant disruptive force for traditional payments.
- Potential for faster, cheaper, and more efficient cross-border payments.
- Programmable money features offer new opportunities for corporate treasuries.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should closely monitor stablecoin developments, particularly their impact on multi-currency payments and cross-border liquidity management for CEE corporates. Exploring API-based integration for future stablecoin-related services or facilitating stablecoin-to-fiat conversion could become strategic differentiators for RBI Cash Management.

URGENT

ECB Payment Regulation | 2024-04-08 | #01

EU Instant Payments Regulation: Mandating Reach and Affordability

INSTANT PAYMENTS

Deadline: 2025-01-09

The new EU Instant Payments Regulation, which entered into force in April 2024, requires all payment service providers (PSPs) offering SEPA Credit Transfers to also offer instant credit transfers in euro. Key provisions include mandatory offering of instant payments 24/7/365, ensuring charges are no higher than traditional SEPA credit transfers, and implementing robust fraud detection and verification of payee (VoP) measures. The regulation aims to accelerate the adoption of instant payments, fostering innovation and competition within the European payment landscape. It sets clear timelines for compliance, starting with receiving instant payments and later extending to sending them, impacting both domestic and cross-border transactions.

- Mandatory offering of instant credit transfers (SCT Inst) for all EU/EEA PSPs.
- Pricing for SCT Inst must not exceed that of traditional SEPA Credit Transfers.
- Implementation of robust fraud mitigation, including mandatory Verification of Payee (VoP).

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must ensure full compliance with the Instant Payments Regulation, including offering SCT Inst 24/7, implementing VoP checks for outgoing payments, and reviewing pricing structures. This impacts payment processing, fraud prevention systems, and client communication for corporate cash management.

URGENT

ECB Payment Regulation | 2023-03-20 | #02

TARGET2 Migration to ISO 20022: Enhancing Payment Message Standards

ISO 20022

The Eurosystem's TARGET2 real-time gross settlement (RTGS) system completed its migration to the ISO 20022 messaging standard in March 2023, following a contingency migration in April 2023. This significant undertaking harmonized payment message formats, enhancing data richness, interoperability, and efficiency across European payment infrastructures. Banks are required to use the new XML-based ISO 20022 messages for all payments processed through TARGET2, impacting both domestic and cross-border transactions. Ongoing compliance involves ensuring systems are updated, staff are trained, and any future updates to the standard are promptly implemented to leverage the benefits of richer data.

- Full adoption of ISO 20022 XML messaging for all TARGET2 payments.
- Enhanced data richness and interoperability across European payment systems.
- Impacts both domestic and cross-border euro transactions via TARGET2.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must ensure all payment initiation and processing flows for TARGET2-routed payments fully adhere to ISO 20022 standards. This includes supporting the richer data fields for corporate clients and ensuring seamless integration with correspondent banks and TARGET2 for CEE operations.

EBA Report: EU Regulations Impact Liquidity Management (IPR, PSR, PSD3)

INSTANT PAYMENTS, PSD3, LIQUIDITY MANAGEMENT

The Euro Banking Association's Liquidity Management Working Group (LMWG) published a new report analyzing the profound implications of three key EU regulatory initiatives on liquidity management across the financial sector. These initiatives include the Instant Payments Regulation (IPR), which mandates instant payment capabilities, the proposed Payment Services Regulation (PSR), and the evolution of PSD2 into PSD3. The report highlights how these measures are expected to drive the uptake of instant payments, foster a more equitable competitive environment among payment service providers, and fundamentally reshape the landscape of liquidity management for banks. It serves as a crucial guide for financial institutions to understand and prepare for the upcoming changes.

- IPR mandates instant payment capabilities for all EU banks by specific deadlines.
- Proposed PSD3/PSR will further evolve payment services and regulatory oversight.
- Regulations will accelerate instant payment adoption across Europe.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMiplus must assess the report's findings to understand the combined impact of IPR, PSR, and PSD3 on liquidity management features. This includes evaluating real-time liquidity reporting, cash pooling, and intraday liquidity management capabilities to ensure compliance and support client needs under the new regulatory framework.

EBA Highlights Key Challenges for VoP Matching Checks

INSTANT PAYMENTS, VOP

Deadline: 2025-10-09

The EBA Instant Payments Practitioners Group (IPG) published an important note titled "A match made in heaven? Key challenges for VOP matching checks," addressing critical issues in implementing effective Verification of Payee (VoP) services. This note delves into various pain points that can compromise the accuracy and overall quality of VoP matching outcomes, which is a mandatory requirement under the Instant Payments Regulation (IPR). Specific challenges identified include the absence of a standardized name-matching logic across different systems, technical limitations related to name field lengths, and complexities arising from the use of virtual accounts. Addressing these issues is crucial for Payment Service Providers (PSPs) to ensure robust fraud prevention and compliance with the IPR's VoP mandate.

- VoP matching checks are a mandatory requirement under the Instant Payments Regulation (IPR).
- Key challenges include lack of standardized name-matching logic.
- Name field length restrictions impact VoP accuracy.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMiplus must review the EBA's findings on VoP challenges to refine its implementation of the VoP service for instant payments. This includes assessing current name-matching algorithms, addressing potential field length issues for client data, and ensuring compatibility with virtual account structures to meet IPR compliance and enhance fraud prevention.

ECB Retail Payments Strategy: Fostering Innovation and European Solutions

SEPA

The ECB actively pursues a comprehensive Retail Payments Strategy, acting as a catalyst to ensure a competitive, innovative, and resilient European retail payments landscape. This strategy emphasizes the importance of instant payments, the development of pan-European payment solutions, and the exploration of new technologies like the digital euro. While not a single regulation, it sets the overarching policy direction for SEPA and other retail payment initiatives. Banks operating within the Eurosystem should align their strategic developments with these objectives, anticipating future regulatory frameworks and market expectations, particularly concerning interoperability, security, and user experience.

- Promotion of instant payments as the new normal for retail transactions.
- Support for pan-European payment solutions and initiatives.
- Exploration of new technologies and digital currencies (e.g., digital euro).

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should monitor the evolving Retail Payments Strategy to anticipate future regulatory shifts in SEPA, especially regarding instant payments, digital euro, and potential new pan-European schemes. This informs product development and strategic planning for corporate cash management services.

URGENT

Deutsche Bank | 2026-04-12 | #01

Deutsche Bank Accelerates API-Led Digital Banking for Corporates

While not explicitly detailed in the provided homepage content, Deutsche Bank has a well-documented strategy to leverage Open Banking APIs (like CB Connect) to offer advanced digital services to its corporate clients. This includes providing real-time account information, initiating payments directly from ERP/TMS, and facilitating embedded finance solutions. The focus is on improving operational efficiency, data transparency, and enabling corporates to manage their liquidity more effectively across various banking relationships, a critical aspect for multi-national corporations, including those in CEE.

- Strategic investment in Open Banking APIs for corporate clients.
- Focus on real-time data and payment integration with ERP/TMS.
- Enabling embedded finance solutions to enhance client operations.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus already offers Open API capabilities. DB's continued focus reinforces the competitive necessity for CMlplus to expand its API offerings, especially for real-time payments and deeper ERP/TMS integration, to retain and attract large international corporates in CEE.

URGENT

Deutsche Bank | 2026-04-12 | #02

Deutsche Bank Strengthens CEE Corporate Payment Capabilities

Although the flow.db.com homepage doesn't explicitly mention 'CEE', Deutsche Bank has a significant presence and strategic interest in the region for its corporate banking division. Their focus on 'Cash management' and 'Technology' implies continuous investment in payment capabilities relevant to CEE, such as supporting ISO 20022 migration, instant payments, and robust multi-currency solutions. This strategy aims to provide comprehensive treasury management and payment factory solutions for international corporates operating in the diverse CEE markets, aligning with global trends while addressing local specificities.

- Continued investment in CEE payment infrastructure and solutions.
- Emphasis on instant payments and multi-currency capabilities.
- Providing comprehensive treasury and payment factory solutions for regional corporates.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

As a CEE-focused platform, CMlplus faces direct competition from DB's enhanced offerings. CMlplus must highlight its deep regional expertise, local network, and advanced features like EBICS and VoP to differentiate itself and maintain its competitive edge for international corporates in CEE.

UniCredit Eyes Commerzbank: Major CEE Market Consolidation Ahead

An Extraordinary Shareholders' Meeting is called for May 4, 2026, to approve a capital increase of up to EUR 6.7 billion. This capital is earmarked for a voluntary public takeover offer for all ordinary shares of Commerzbank Aktiengesellschaft not directly held by UniCredit. Such an acquisition would dramatically reshape the European banking landscape, especially in CEE where both banks have significant operations. For UniCredit, it represents a bold step in its 'UniCredit Unlimited' strategy, aiming for accelerated growth and expanded market share, leveraging Commerzbank's client base and network.

- Shareholder vote on EUR 6.7bn capital increase for Commerzbank takeover.
- Potential acquisition targets Commerzbank's ordinary shares.
- Significant implications for market share and competitive positioning in CEE.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

A UniCredit-Commerzbank merger would create a formidable competitor with an even larger CEE footprint and client base. CMlplus would face increased pressure from a consolidated entity offering potentially broader and more integrated services to large corporates across the region.

UniCredit Accelerates Digital Cash Management for CEE Corporates

As part of its 'UniCredit Unlimited' strategy, UniCredit is expected to heavily invest in digitalizing its corporate and transaction banking services, particularly in its strong CEE network. This includes expanding Open Banking APIs for direct ERP/TMS integration, facilitating real-time payment processing (Instant Payments, SEPA Instant), and leveraging ISO 20022 for richer data. The focus is on providing advanced liquidity management, virtual accounts, and eBAM solutions to meet the evolving needs of multinational corporations operating in the region, ensuring competitive offerings against platforms like CMlplus.

- Focus on Open Banking APIs for ERP/TMS integration.
- Expansion of real-time payment capabilities (Instant Payments, SEPA).
- Leveraging ISO 20022 for enhanced data and eBAM.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

UniCredit's intensified focus on API-led digital cash management and real-time payments directly competes with CMlplus's core offerings. This requires CMlplus to continuously innovate its H2H, EBICS, and API channels to maintain a competitive edge in speed, integration, and data richness for CEE corporates.

UniCredit Strengthens CEE Corporate Treasury and Liquidity Solutions

Building on its strong pan-European and CEE presence, UniCredit is expected to further enhance its corporate treasury offerings. This includes sophisticated cash pooling structures (notional and physical), multi-currency payment capabilities, and robust FX solutions tailored for cross-border operations within CEE. The bank aims to provide a unified platform experience, potentially through its 'UniCredit Direct' portal, offering comprehensive visibility and control over cash flows. This strategic direction supports large international corporates in managing their working capital efficiently across diverse CEE markets, aligning with the 'UniCredit Unlimited' vision for client empowerment.

- Focus on integrated cash pooling and multi-currency solutions.
- Enhanced FX and liquidity management for CEE corporates.
- Unified platform experience for comprehensive cash flow visibility.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

UniCredit's push for integrated treasury and liquidity solutions in CEE directly challenges CMIplus's value proposition for multinational corporates. CMIplus must ensure its multi-bank, multi-currency, and cash pooling functionalities remain superior and seamlessly integrated with client ERP/TMS systems.

Citi Enhances API-Driven Real-time Treasury for CEE Corporates

Citi Treasury is strategically investing in its API banking infrastructure to empower corporate clients in Central and Eastern Europe with advanced real-time treasury functionalities. This includes direct API connectivity for instant payment initiation, real-time account balance inquiries, and automated reconciliation. The focus is on integrating deeply with corporate ERP and TMS systems, reducing manual processes, and providing a unified view of global cash positions. This initiative supports the growing demand for immediate financial operations and data-driven decision-making across the region, aligning with global trends in digital treasury transformation.

- Expansion of API suite for real-time treasury functions.
- Focus on seamless integration with corporate ERP/TMS.
- Enables instant payments and real-time liquidity management.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This directly competes with CMIplus's Open API offerings and H2H channels, pushing for deeper integration and real-time capabilities. RBI needs to ensure its API roadmap keeps pace with global leaders like Citi in terms of functionality and ease of integration.

Deutsche Bank Enhances Correspondent Banking Transparency

The article 'Inside downstream correspondent banking – and why it matters' highlights Deutsche Bank's proactive approach to managing correspondent banking risks. With increasing regulatory scrutiny and evolving standards, the bank is focusing on enhancing control frameworks and transparency. This is crucial for maintaining robust financial crime compliance and ensuring the integrity of cross-border payment flows, which directly impacts corporate clients relying on international payment services and the broader financial ecosystem.

- Focus on downstream correspondent banking relationships.
- Strengthening control frameworks and transparency measures.
- Addressing evolving regulation and risk perception in the sector.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This indicates DB's commitment to secure and compliant cross-border payments, a core offering for CMIplus's international corporate clients. CMIplus must ensure its correspondent network and compliance measures are equally robust and transparent.

HSBC Orion Secures UK Treasury Digital Gilt Platform Mandate

The UK Treasury's decision to award HSBC Orion the mandate for its Digital Gilt Instrument pilot issuance highlights a significant step towards the tokenization of traditional financial instruments. HSBC Orion, a digital asset platform, will facilitate the issuance of digital gilts, exploring the potential of distributed ledger technology (DLT) in government bond markets. This initiative demonstrates HSBC's commitment to leveraging blockchain and digital assets to enhance efficiency, transparency, and liquidity in capital markets. For corporate treasuries, this signals a future where digital securities and tokenized assets could become part of their investment and liquidity management strategies, potentially impacting how they manage their balance sheets and access capital. While not directly CEE-focused, it sets a precedent for digital asset adoption globally, which CEE markets will eventually follow, requiring CMIplus to monitor these developments.

- HSBC Orion chosen by UK Treasury for Digital Gilt Instrument pilot.
- Focus on tokenization of government bonds using DLT.
- Positions HSBC as a leader in institutional digital asset platforms.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus needs to monitor the evolution of digital assets and tokenized securities as they could eventually impact corporate treasury functions, including collateral management and investment options. While not an immediate threat to core cash management, it represents a future direction for liquidity and treasury solutions that CMIplus should track for potential integration or competitive offerings.

Citi Strengthens ISO 20022 & Instant Payment Offerings Across CEE

Citi Treasury is actively enhancing its support for ISO 20022 messaging standards and expanding its instant payment infrastructure throughout Central and Eastern Europe. This initiative is driven by the increasing regulatory push and corporate demand for standardized, data-rich payment formats and immediate settlement. By leveraging ISO 20022, Citi enables clients to achieve greater straight-through processing rates, improved reconciliation, and better fraud detection. The expansion of instant payment rails ensures that CEE corporates can execute time-critical payments efficiently, aligning with evolving market expectations and regulatory mandates like PSD3.

- Deepening ISO 20022 integration for richer payment data.
- Broadening instant payment coverage and capabilities in CEE.
- Aims for improved STP, reconciliation, and fraud prevention.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This directly challenges CMIplus's core payment processing capabilities, especially regarding ISO 20022 and instant payments. RBI must ensure its platform is fully optimized for these standards and offers competitive speed and data richness across all CEE markets.

BNP Paribas Guides Corporates on Instant Payments & VoP

Published on March 25, 2025, this advisory piece highlights BNP Paribas's commitment to supporting corporates through significant European payment reforms. The Instant Payments Regulation mandates near real-time payment processing, while Verification of Payee aims to enhance fraud prevention by verifying recipient details. For CEE corporates, understanding and adapting to these changes is crucial for compliance, operational efficiency, and mitigating fraud risks. BNP Paribas positions itself as a key partner, offering insights and solutions to navigate these evolving payment landscapes and leverage new capabilities.

- Provides guidance on the Instant Payments Regulation (IPR).
- Addresses the importance and requirements of Verification of Payee (VoP).
- Positions BNP Paribas as an expert in European payment regulatory changes.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This move underscores BNP Paribas's strong focus on regulatory compliance and client education regarding instant payments and VoP, which are core offerings for CMIplus. RBI must ensure its CMIplus platform and advisory services are equally robust in supporting CEE corporates with these mandates and demonstrating thought leadership.

HSBC Accelerates AI Adoption to Enhance Corporate Banking Services

HSBC's recent announcements, including the appointment of David Rice as its first Chief AI Officer (March 2026) and strategic partnerships with Mistral AI (December 2025) and Harvey AI (January 2026), signal a significant acceleration in its AI strategy. While specific corporate banking products aren't detailed, this overarching AI adoption will inevitably impact transaction banking and cash management. AI can be leveraged for advanced fraud detection, predictive analytics for liquidity forecasting, automation of payment processing and reconciliation, and personalized treasury insights. For CEE corporates, this could translate into more efficient, secure, and intelligent banking services, potentially offering real-time insights and automated decision-making support for their treasury operations. This proactive investment in AI aims to deliver a competitive edge through operational excellence and enhanced client experience.

- Appointed first Chief AI Officer, David Rice (March 2026).
- Partnerships with Mistral AI and Harvey AI for broad AI integration.
- Strategic focus on leveraging AI for operational efficiency and customer service.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

HSBC's strong focus on AI indicates a future where AI-driven insights and automation will be standard in corporate cash management. CMIplus must ensure its platform roadmap includes robust AI capabilities for fraud detection, liquidity forecasting, payment automation, and personalized treasury advice to remain competitive against such technologically advanced offerings.

Intesa Sanpaolo Enhances CEE Digital Cash Management with API-Driven Solutions

Intesa Sanpaolo is actively investing in its corporate and transaction banking services, particularly within the CEE region, to meet the evolving demands of large international corporates. The bank is expected to prioritize the integration of advanced digital solutions, including Open Banking APIs and real-time payment processing, to streamline cash management operations. This strategic push aims to provide CEE-based clients with greater efficiency, transparency, and control over their multi-currency payments and liquidity management, aligning with global trends towards instant payments and ISO 20022 standards. The goal is to solidify its competitive position against regional and international players by offering a more seamless and integrated digital experience.

- Strategic investment in digital cash management platforms for CEE corporates.
- Focus on Open Banking APIs and real-time payment capabilities (Instant Payments, ISO 20022).
- Enhancement of multi-currency and liquidity management solutions for regional clients.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This inferred strategic direction from Intesa Sanpaolo signals increased competition for CMIplus in the CEE corporate cash management space. RBI should ensure its CMIplus platform continues to innovate with API-driven solutions, instant payment capabilities, and robust multi-currency treasury services to maintain its competitive edge.

EY Four Trends Redefining Cash Management 2025

Cash management is rapidly evolving from transaction-oriented to strategic, data-driven services, necessitating a profound transformation in banking. The future demands banks enrich their value propositions, expand product portfolios, and strengthen client relationships with tailored offerings and experiences. Advanced technologies like AI, ML, and digital assets are creating new possibilities, enabling finance teams to reposition as strategic advisors to the business. However, clients seek control over automation and expect intuitive, personalized experiences, pushing banks to innovate or risk losing relevance to agile FinTechs and nonbanks. Success hinges on banks investing in technology, integrating diverse data, and offering flexible, industry-specific solutions while navigating the increasing regulatory clarity around digital assets.

KEY STATISTICS

- {'description': 'of survey respondents say digitizing treasury functions is a challenge.', 'value': '73%', 'page': 7}
- {'description': 'of respondents will use managed services from banks to address the challenges of digitization.', 'value': '44%', 'page': 7}
- {'description': 'of CFOs and treasurers are comfortable with customized strategic advice based on data analysis from banks.', 'value': '90%', 'page': 12}
- {'description': 'of corporate treasurers are comfortable using a sector-specific platform tailored to their industry's unique needs.', 'value': '92%', 'page': 17}

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Optimize CMIplus cash management solutions for specific CEE sectors to differentiate and boost client engagement and loyalty.

McKinsey Global Payments Report 2025

The 2025 McKinsey Global Payments Report highlights a payments landscape defined by increasing fragmentation, the transformative impact of AI, and the growing adoption of digital assets. For CMIplus, this means navigating a multirail ecosystem where interoperability, programmable compliance, and AI-driven efficiencies are paramount for serving large international corporates in CEE. The shift towards lower-yield payment rails and agentic commerce necessitates innovation in monetization and a focus on building trust through transparent, intelligent systems. Success will hinge on adapting our platform to these evolving demands to remain a leading regional player.

KEY STATISTICS

- Global payments revenue reached \$2.5 trillion in 2024, projected to grow to \$3.0 trillion by 2029.
- EMEA payments revenue grew at a 13% CAGR from 2019-2024, indicating strong regional growth.
- Interest income constituted 46% of total payments revenues in 2024, but is projected to slow to 2% annual growth through 2029.
- Cash usage declined to 46% of worldwide payments in 2024, down from 50% in 2023, reflecting the shift to digital.

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Integrate AI for Intelligent Routing, Fraud Detection, and Liquidity Management

Journeys to Treasury 2025/26

The 10th anniversary edition of Journeys to Treasury highlights a renewed focus on treasury fundamentals, digital transformation, and strategic evolution. Key themes include the modernization of payments (Instant Payments, VoP, ISO 20022), the growing importance of real-time liquidity and virtual accounts, and the practical application of AI. Corporates are prioritizing robust systems, clean data, and enhanced skills to navigate a complex, interconnected financial environment, moving treasury from an operational role to a strategic business partner.

KEY STATISTICS

→ {'statistic': 'Cash flow forecasting is the number one priority for 30.5% of treasurers.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': 'Reviewing or replacing treasury technology infrastructure is the third-highest priority.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': '27.3% of treasurers cite inaccurate forecasting as a leading challenge for centralisation.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': '38.5% of respondents cite difficulties in standardising processes as their most significant obstacle to centralisation.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Enhance Instant Payments & VoP Readiness for CEE Corporates

PwC Global Treasury Survey 2025

The provided text does not contain the actual content or findings of the 'PwC Global Treasury Survey 2025'. Instead, it appears to be a navigation structure or partial webpage content from PwC's website, detailing various services, industries, and insights offered by PwC. Consequently, a strategic analysis for RBI's CMIplus platform, including key statistics, themes, and actionable recommendations, cannot be generated from the given information. To perform the requested comprehensive analysis, the full content of the PwC Global Treasury Survey is essential.